

power of technology to reach out to India's unbanked communities. The use of artificial intelligence (AI) to profile prospective finserv customers would only increase in the years to come. A higher degree of internet penetration would enable financial product manufacturers to bring their costs down. This will mark the beginning of customised financial products for low-income earners living in rural India.

Our healthcare sector is also undergoing a transformative change thanks to emerging tech. Apart from being the world's pharmacy, India is developing novel treatment and disease management methods at a much lower cost than the western world. Hence, India's tech-driven healthcare and pharma sector would benefit not just India, but the entire world.

India's manufacturing sector is passing through digital transformation, with many large manufacturers moving on from simple digitisation to convergence. Large manufacturers, such as Mahindra, have already started initiating a crossover to 'Industry 4.0', which simply means the

linking up of products with means of production. By doing so, manufacturers can optimise their production schedules and create more value for the business.

By 2047, the automotive industry, of which we are a major part, may have made a significant shift to electric vehicles (EVs). Our future wheels could be far more advanced versions of the 'connected cars' that automakers are unveiling now. Future cars could have AI-powered safety standards as well as cutting-edge battery packs for longer driving ranges and faster recharge times.

Similar technological advancements are seen across critical sectors such as education, agriculture, power generation and real estate. AI and ML (machine learning) would revolutionise our classrooms in the years to come—making education more democratic and accessible to all sections of our society. In the coming decades, the agriculture sector is projected to experience a significant increase in tech-based inputs. FaaS (farming-as-a-service) would take off in a big way with 'smart technologies' predicting weather, crop, yield,

market, disease and price. On the hardware side, we will see a lot more farm mechanisation happening over the next few years.

India's power and real estate sectors would evolve to become more planet-friendly in the coming decades. Our country may have added a lot more renewable energy (RE) to its power mix by 2047. This will bring down the cost of electricity at the consumer end by a significant measure.

The most important technological advances would revolve around combating climate change and ensuring sustainability. Climate tech is a sunrise sector now. But over the next 25 years, it will emerge as the most significant one for the survival of the human race. Technology will make significant inroads into every industry we know today.

Business groups with strong balance sheets have the moral obligation to invest in newer technologies that will make the world a better place for all.

Lastly, we should be conscious of the fact that India's demographic dividend is expected to peak around 2041, when our share of the working-age population is expected to reach nearly 60 per cent. We should support young students, who are particularly inclined to science and technology. A large number of our future technocrats and scientists would emerge from this cluster.

When I look ahead 25 years, I see a green hilltop of technological breakthroughs—and not an abyss of impossibility. I am reasonably confident that we will see a number of groundbreaking inventions and innovations, some of which will be the best since the beginning of 'sliced bread'. **BT**

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